

Backup & Persistence Strategy — CRITICAL INFORMATION

Question answered: “Do I need to copy the full zip and project files or all OK from here?”

Short answer: Files in `/home/ubuntu/` persist for the lifetime of THIS chat/VM only.

If you start a NEW chat, the easiest way to get the project back is to **push to GitHub now** and clone it later. Downloading the ZIP is a fine secondary safety net.

VM File Persistence Rules

What Persists WITHIN This Conversation

-  Files in `/home/ubuntu/` stay available while this chat/VM is active
-  Git commits remain in the local repo
-  All created files remain accessible across messages
-  You can work across multiple messages without re-uploading

What Does NOT Persist After Chat Ends

-  Local files in `/home/ubuntu/` are **not guaranteed** to be available in a NEW conversation
 -  The VM shuts down after an inactivity period
 -  Uncommitted changes may be lost when the VM stops
 -  Local-only repos (not pushed to GitHub) may be lost
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RECOMMENDATION: Push to GitHub ASAP

Option A — GitHub as primary backup (BEST)

-  Push `cryo_leak_rate_dashboard` to GitHub NOW
-  All files backed up remotely
-  Can clone in any new chat session
-  Version controlled and shareable
-  No manual download/upload cycles

```
cd /home/ubuntu/cryo_leak_rate_dashboard
git remote add origin https://github.com/GB0GEB/cryo_leak_rate_dashboard.git
git push -u origin main
git push --tags origin
```

Result: Everything safe on GitHub forever.

Option B — Download ZIP (manual safety copy)

-  Click the **Files** button in the chat UI (top right) and download the project directory
-  Keep a local backup on your computer

- ⚠️ Must re-upload in new chat sessions to continue
- ⚠️ Manual version management — no history beyond what you ZIP

Use case: You can't or don't want to push to GitHub right now.

Option C — Both (RECOMMENDED)

- ✅ Push to GitHub (primary backup)
- ✅ Download ZIP (local safety copy)
- ✅ Best of both worlds

What to Back Up

MUST back up (unique, hand-authored content)

1. **Source code** — `src/`
2. **Configuration / SSoT** — `data/config.yaml` , `data/*.json`
3. **Documentation** — all `.md` files at the repo root
4. **Tests** — `tests/`
5. **Scripts** — `scripts/` , `setup.sh` , `build.sh` , `validate.sh` , `package.sh`
6. **Templates** — `repo_templates/`
7. **Version metadata** — `VERSION` , `VERSION.json` , `CHANGELOG.md`

Can be regenerated (do not need to back up)

- `docs/*.html` (rebuild via `./build.sh`)
- `outputs/` (rebuild via build scripts)
- `dist/` (rebuild via `./package.sh`)
- `__pycache__/` , `.pytest_cache/` , `htmlcov/` , `.coverage` (Python temp)
- `venv/` (recreate via `./setup.sh`)

Already on GitHub (if pushed)

- All committed files
- Full git history
- Tags and branches

For Reuse in NEW Chat Sessions

If pushed to GitHub

```
# In a fresh chat:
git clone https://github.com/GB0GEB/cryo_leak_rate_dashboard.git
cd cryo_leak_rate_dashboard
./setup.sh
./build.sh
```

Result: Full project restored in ~2 minutes.

If only a local ZIP backup

- 1. Upload the ZIP in the new chat
- 2. Extract: `unzip cryo_leak_rate_dashboard.zip -d /home/ubuntu/`
- 3. Rebuild:

```
bash
cd /home/ubuntu/cryo_leak_rate_dashboard
./setup.sh && ./build.sh
```

Result: Project restored in ~5 minutes.

✓ CURRENT STATUS (as of this commit)

- 🟡 **Local state:** v4.0.0 fully committed locally — `git status` clean
- 🔴 **GitHub state:** No remote configured yet — **at risk** if the VM shuts down
- 📄 **Local commits not yet on GitHub:** all of them (the repo has never been pushed)

RECOMMENDED ACTION

Push to GitHub in the next 5 minutes. Follow `GITHUB_REPO_CREATION_STEPS.md` .

🧠 Mental model for future chats

Think of this VM as a **scratch workspace**, not durable storage.
GitHub is your **durable workspace**. Every meaningful change should end on GitHub.

Storage	Durable?	Survives new chat?	Use it for
<code>/home/ubuntu/</code> in this chat	⚠ Short-term	✗ No	Scratch / in-progress work
Local ZIP on your computer	✓ Yes	✓ Yes (after upload)	Offline safety copy
GitHub repo	✓ Yes	✓ Yes (just clone)	Primary source of truth